

SUNDAY 30 AUGUST 2026

Twenty Second Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:

Aghyaran • Ardstraw West & Castlederg • Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

Parish Office: Parochial House, 16 Castlefin Road, Castlederg, BT81 7BT. Tel: 028 816 71393

Parish websites (*including access to church webcams*) and emails:

Aghyaran: Website: parishofaghyaran.com Email: aghyaranparish@derrydiocese.org

Drumquin: Website: drumquinparish.com Email: drumquin@derrydiocese.org

Ardstraw West & Castlederg: Web: castledergparish.com Email: castledergparish@derrydiocese.org

DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON:

Ms Marie O'Kane – Telephone 07596500793 Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 31 August		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 1 Sept	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 2 Sept			Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 3 Sept	Mass, 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon		
Friday 4 Sept		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon	
Saturday 5 Sept	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm: <i>First Anniversary, Isobel Coyle</i>	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 6 Sept	Mass, 11.00am	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Drumnabey, 12.30pm <i>Mass in Castlederg on 13 & 27 Sept</i>	Mass, 11.00am

Please note that Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament resumes this week in Aghyaran and Castlederg, on 3 and 4 September respectively, as above. Liturgy of the Word will resume the following week.

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £865 & €10. Church Restoration Fund: £809 & €77.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,220 & €136, made up of:

Castlederg £1,413 & €80, Drumnabey £453 & €36, Dregish £354. **DRUMQUIN:** £608.

ARDSTRAW WEST AND CASTLEDERG PARISH DRAW: The August draw will take place after Mass in Dregish this Sunday. Good luck to everyone.

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We pray for the happy repose of the souls of Gerry O'Kane, Dooish Road, whose Funeral Mass took place in Drumquin on Thursday, and Danny O'Donnell, Meenamullin Road, Killeter, whose Funeral Mass took place in Aghyaran on Friday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to their families and to all who mourn their deaths. May they rest in peace.

Please remember in prayer our young parishioners, family members and friends who are returning to school this week or are starting school for the first time. We continue to remember in prayer all who are preparing to commence third-level education at this time and those who are taking up employment for the first time. **May Your love be upon them, O Lord, as they place all their trust in You.**

- ♦ **HAVE YOU EVER** lifted the Bible with the intention of reading it....but maybe just managed a few pages, before giving up in vain?
- ♦ **DID YOU KNOW** that the Bible is not actually a book? It is a Library - of 73 books.
- ♦ **HAVE YOU EVER THOUGHT ABOUT** how the books of the Bible fit together – move along a timeline - to reveal God's plan for our salvation?
- ♦ **WOULD YOU LIKE TO GAIN** a deeper knowledge and understanding of the Bible so that, when reading or listening to the Scripture readings at Mass on Sunday, you will have a much clearer understanding of them and of how they apply to our everyday lives?

It is our aim over the next number of weeks to **take the 'mystery' out of the Bible** and to give us all a whole new understanding and love of God's Word. In **St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg**, we are going to run an eight-week Bible Study course called **"Unlocking the mysteries of the Bible."** It will take place over the course of **eight Wednesday evenings, commencing 9 September, from 7.30 – 9.00pm**. This course is presented by renowned Catholic speaker Jeff Cavins who, through engaging video presentations and his acclaimed **Bible Timeline** approach, will literally unlock the mystery of the Bible for us.

There will be opportunity for small-group discussion, with the aid of a workbook, with which you will be provided. There is a suggested donation of £15, which will include your workbook, a colour-coded Bible Timeline Card which will be a useful tool as we move along the 'timeline' of the course. Refreshments will be provided.

You can book for the course in advance via Fr Paul / the Parish Office or just come along and enrol on Wednesday 9 September. Let us unlock the mystery of the Bible together. Everyone is welcome.

PASTORAL VISITATION OF THE HOUSEBOUND will take place this week as follows:

Monday 31 Aug: Dregish, commencing at 11.00am. **Thursday 3 Sept:** Corgary, Tullicar, Aghyaran, Killeter, Scraghey, Coolcreaghy, Shanog Road, Laghel Road, commencing after 10.00am Mass – Fr Paul. **Friday 4 Sept:** Garvagh, The Laghts, Lisnacloon, Magheranageeragh, Mullinabreen, Trienamongan, commencing 11.00am – Fr Paul.

LORETO GRAMMAR SCHOOL, OMAGH: Arrangements for School Opening: Years 9, 10 & 11 only – Tue 1 Sept; Years 8 & 12 only – Wed 2 Sept; Years 13 & 14 only – Thurs 3 Sept; All pupils – Fri 4 Sept.

RISE AND SHINE TRUST – Easter 2027 Pilgrimage: Applications are invited from young people with additional social, emotional, physical and learning needs aged 11-30 who are interested in travelling as guests to Lourdes with Rise and Shine Trust. The trip is free to Guests. Application form available on riseandshine.ie. Closing date 15 October. Applications also sought for carers aged 18+ who would be interested in accompanying guests. Applications at riseandshine.ie. Visit www.riseandshine.ie or contact Sian (07960211352) or Maurice (07711504821).

CATHOLIC MOTHERS IRELAND – FAMILY DAY: Annual National Mass, Sunday 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. For more information and booking details, email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome.

ARANDERG CCÉ Irish Traditional Music Sessions start back next Friday, 4 September, at 9.00pm in Killeter Heritage. Everyone is welcome!

TEAM HOPE FUNDRAISING GARDEN PARTY – this Friday, 4 September, 2.00 – 7.00pm, 30 Lurganbuoy Road, Castlederg. Live music with Macdara O'Dwyer. Tea, coffee, treats, raffle, garden games, fun for children and families. Deborah Lowry wishes you to know that everyone is welcome - drop in at any time during the afternoon or evening.

IRISH DANCING resumes on **Tuesday 8 September**, at **6.00pm** in **Drumquin Community Youth Centre**. New beginners P1 and above are welcome to join. Text / call Dolores on 07739631478.

BLESSING OF BIKERS AND MOYORCYCLES will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLi Station, to present the donation to the RNLi.

Season of Creation 2026: 1 September to 4 October

The annual celebration of Season of Creation aims to bring Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, *Living Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation. The theme is inspired by the vision of hope and renewal found in the Book of Ezekiel, 47:9: "Wherever the river flows, every living creature that swarms will live... and everything will live where the river goes."